



OpenAI finally breaks on Suchir Balaji's death

Suchir Balaji, a former OpenAI researcher and whistleblower, recently found dead in his San Francisco apartment. Authorities ruled his death a suicide, stating there was no evidence of foul play. Balaji, just 26 years old, had made headlines a few months earlier by accusing OpenAI of breaking copyright laws while creating ChatGPT. His claims added weight to ongoing lawsuits against the company.

Now, OpenAI has released an official statement addressing his death. The company expressed sadness over the loss and extended support to Balaji's family. In a post on X (formerly Twitter), OpenAI said:

"We were devastated to learn of this tragic news and have been in touch with Suchir's family to offer our full support during this difficult time. Our priority is to continue to do everything we can to assist them. Suchir was a valued member of our team, and his passing has deeply affected those who worked closely with him.

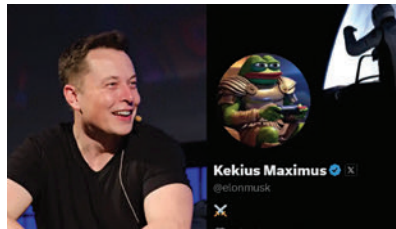
We first became aware of his concerns when The New York Times published his comments and we have no record of any further interaction with him. We respect his, and others', right to share views freely. Our hearts go out to Suchir's loved ones, and we extend our deepest condolences to all who are mourning his loss."

<https://bit.ly/42b7XZU>

■ MUSKY AFFAIR

Elon Musk's profile update to 'Kekius Maximus' causes 900pct surge in this crypto memecoin price

Elon Musk, the CEO of Tesla and SpaceX, recently caused a stir online after changing his handle on X (formerly Twitter) to 'Kekius Maximus.' This unexpected move left his massive following of over 210 million users curious. Musk has yet to explain the reason behind the



change, leading to a flurry of speculation. The name, 'Kekius Maximus,' seems to blend internet culture with a nod to ancient history. The first part, 'Kekius,' is likely a play on 'kek,' an internet slang term used similarly to 'lol' (laugh out loud), popular in online

gaming and certain internet communities. The second part, 'Maximus,' references the famous Roman general Maximus Decimus Meridius. Musk had also updated his profile picture, replacing it with an image of Pepe the Frog dressed as a Roman soldier, holding a video game joystick.

<https://bit.ly/3PuxCVQ>

■ FRUITY ECOSYSTEM

Tim Cook says Apple doesn't plan to charge for AI features

Apple has taken a different path in the tech world when it comes to artificial intelligence (AI). While many companies are looking for ways to make money from AI-powered services, Apple's CEO, Tim Cook, has made it clear that charging for AI isn't part of their plan. In a recent interview with WIRED's Steven Levy, Cook explained that Apple sees AI as a core technology, much like multitouch, which



transformed smartphones and tablets. This reflects Apple's strategy of adding advanced features to its products without asking users to pay extra – provided they already own Apple devices.

During the interview, Levy asked Cook if Apple ever considered charging for its new AI-powered features introduced in iOS 18.1 and iOS 18.2. Cook responded, "We never talked about charging for it. We view it sort of like multitouch, which enabled the smartphone revolution and the modern tablet." <https://bit.ly/4j6llz8>